

VentureMiner AI

Sales Playbook

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How we sell VentureMiner AI. The motions, the messaging, the qualification framework, and the plays per persona and tier.

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1. Purpose & Scope

This document is the contract for the sales motion. It governs:

- How inbound and outbound leads are qualified.
- The messaging framework per persona.
- The discovery → demo → proposal flow.
- Objection handling.
- Hand-off to customer success.

It does not cover marketing (which is a separate function) or pricing (Document 31).

2. Sales principles

1. Value first. Every conversation starts with the customer's problem, not our product.
2. Evidence-led. Every claim we make is backed by a real artifact we can show.

3. Personas & buying centers

3.1 Primary buyers (per PRD §5)

- P-1: Indie Founder — Solo, self-serve, no sales touch.
- P-2: Corporate Innovator — Team/Enterprise; champion + economic buyer + procurement.
- P-3: Early-Stage Investor — Team; champion + ops/admin.
- P-4: Consultant — Team; champion + practice lead.

3.2 Buying centers (Enterprise)

Champion	Director, Innovation	Discovery speed, evidence quality
Economic buyer	VP Strategy / Head of Corp Dev	ROI, defensibility
Technical evaluator	Data / IT / Security	Security, integration, data residency
Procurement	Procurement Manager	Contract terms, vendor risk
Legal	Counsel	DPA, MSA, IP
End users	Analysts, researchers	Day-to-day experience

We must build a coalition of at least 3 of these before close.

4. Messaging framework

4.1 Core message

VentureMiner AI turns market signals into validated, monetizable SaaS opportunities — in hours, not quarters.

4.2 Per persona

Indie founder	"Spend time building, not researching."	Time-to-first-report: 45 min
Corp innovator	"Quarterly board reports, in days, not months."	Sample board report (anonymized)
Investor	"Source off-market; write memos in 90s."	Sample deal memo
Consultant	"Deliver 3x more engagements per quarter."	Sample client report (white-label)

4.3 Differentiators

- Multi-agent research depth.

- Designed for operators, not just researchers.

4.4 Anti-messaging (never claim)

- "100% accurate" (we are explicit about confidence).
- "Replaces your analyst" (we augment, not replace).
- "Magic" (we are rigorous, not magical).

5. Lead lifecycle

MQL → SAL → SQL → Demo → Proposal → Negotiation → Closed-Won → Hand-off to CS

- MQL (Marketing Qualified Lead) — sign-up, content download, event.
- SAL (Sales Accepted Lead) — BDR confirms fit.
- SQL (Sales Qualified Lead) — BDR/AE schedules discovery.
- Demo — first product demo.
- Proposal — written proposal + scope + price.
- Negotiation — legal/procurement.
- Closed-Won — contract signed.
- Hand-off — to CS.

6. Qualification (MEDDPICC)

- Metrics — what does success look like in dollars / hours?
- Economic buyer — who signs?
- Decision criteria — what does the eval look like?
- Decision process — what's the steps and timeline?
- Paper process — legal, procurement, security review.
- Implication of pain — what happens if they do nothing?
- Champion — who's selling internally for us?
- Competition — what else are they evaluating?

We use MEDDPICC to qualify; no discovery without a champion identified.

7. Discovery calls

7.1 Structure (45 min)

1. 5 min — rapport + agenda.
2. 15 min — their problem (open-ended, listen).
3. 10 min — current process + pain.

7.2 Discovery questions (per persona)

Indie founder (Solo — usually self-serve, no live call): N/A.

Corp innovator (Enterprise):

- "How do you identify adjacencies today?"
- "How long does a board report take today?"
- "Who consumes the output, and what's the cadence?"
- "What's the cost of a missed opportunity?"

Investor (Team):

- "How do you source off-market today?"
- "How long does a deal memo take?"
- "How many meetings per sourced opportunity?"

Consultant (Team):

- "How do you scope an engagement today?"
- "What does a client deliverable look like?"
- "How many concurrent engagements can your team run?"

8. Demos

8.1 Principles

- Their data, their problem. Use a relevant seed in the demo.
- Live, not slides. Live product > 50 slides.
- Cited evidence. Show the citation panel — that's our differentiator.
- Their stakeholders. Tailor to who's on the call.

8.2 Demo flow (30 min)

1. 3 min — context, what we'll show.
2. 5 min — discovery in their industry.
3. 7 min — validation on a candidate opportunity.
4. 5 min — scoring + custom rubric.
5. 7 min — report (one-page brief + full report preview).
6. 3 min — Q&A; + next step.

9. Objection handling

"We already use ChatGPT/Perplexity"	"Those are general-purpose; we're domain-tuned for venture intelligence. Let me show the difference on a real example."
"Too expensive"	"Compare to the cost of one analyst FTE; we're a fraction. And we don't replace — we amplify."
"Data privacy"	"SOC 2 in progress; per-tenant DEKs; data residency options; DPA available. I'll send the security one-pager."
"Hallucination"	"Every claim is cited. The verifier audits citations. Here's the citation panel in a live report."
"We need a pilot first"	"Great — we have a 3-month pilot program with success criteria. Let me send the pilot scope."
"Procurement is slow"	"Standard 12-month MSA, custom DPA, vendor risk form on file. We can move quickly."
"Not the right time"	"Understood. Can I check back in 60 days? I'll send a relevant report in the meantime."

10. Proposals & quoting

- Standard proposal template (PDF, 5 pages).
- Includes: problem, solution, scope, success criteria, timeline, price, terms.
- SOW for Enterprise; pre-approved by Legal.
- Quote via Salesforce CPQ; integrated with Stripe.
- Procurement form pre-filled for known customers.

11. Closing

- Verbal close → written close → signed. No signature without a verbal confirmation.
- Procurement & legal walked in parallel when ACV > \$50k.
- Security review scheduled immediately; pre-filled questionnaire available.
- Counter-offers routed to Sales Lead + Deal Desk.

12. Hand-off to CS

Within 5 business days of close:

- Kickoff call scheduled.
- Implementation plan drafted.
- Admin training scheduled.
- Success plan co-authored.

13. Sales tooling

- CRM: Salesforce.
- Outreach: Apollo + LinkedIn Sales Navigator.
- Demos: Loom + live product.
- Proposals: Pandadoc.
- Quotes: Salesforce CPQ.
- Contract: Ironclad.
- Forecasting: Clari.

14. Sales metrics

MQL → SQL conversion	25%
SQL → Closed-Won	22% (Team) / 35% (Enterprise)
Average sales cycle (Team)	21 days
Average sales cycle (Enterprise)	90 days
Pipeline coverage	3x quota
Forecast accuracy (within 10%)	80%
Net new ARR per AE	\$1.2M (Year 1)
Quota attainment	70% of AEs at 100%+

15. Plays (per stage)

15.1 Outbound — Corp innovator

- LinkedIn message → email → 5-touch sequence.
- Hook: a sample report in their industry.
- CTA: 20-min discovery.

15.2 Inbound demo request

- Acknowledge within 1h.
- Schedule within 24h.
- Pre-call: send relevant case study.
- Demo: their industry.

15.3 Champion enablement

- Co-author a one-pager for the economic buyer

15.4 Procurement acceleration

- Pre-filled vendor risk form.
- Standard MSA with redlines pre-reviewed.
- Security one-pager + SOC 2 letter of intent.

15.5 Renewal motion

- T-90: value snapshot report.
- T-60: QBR with stakeholder expansion.
- T-30: renewal proposal.

16. Appendix

16.1 Glossary

MQL	Marketing Qualified Lead
SAL	Sales Accepted Lead
SQL	Sales Qualified Lead
AE	Account Executive
BDR	Business Development Rep
CSM	Customer Success Manager
ACV	Annual Contract Value
QBR	Quarterly Business Review

16.2 Revision history

v0.5	2026-07-20	Doc Team	All sections drafted
v1.0	2026-07-20	Doc Team	First approved version

16.3 Cross-references

- Pricing & Packaging: Document 31.
- Onboarding: Document 37.
- Operations: Document 28.

End of Document 32 — Sales Playbook. The playbook is the floor, not the ceiling — great reps personalize.